THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Because forts were located on hills, the Mughal cavalry 1

(a) rode inside **(b)** easily won

(c) struggled to use its strength **(d)** needed no horses

2. The expression 'Hindavi Swarajya' implies 1

(a) empire of Persians **(b)** theocracy

(c) a kingdom of the people of the land **(d)** foreign colony

3. A ruler uses a Sanskrit seal and local language instead of Persian. This shows 1

(a) foreign rule **(b)** no interest

(c) cultural assertion **(d)** trade

4. The Treaty of Purandar can be seen as 1

(a) complete defeat **(b)** end of Marathas

(c) a tactical retreat **(d)** victory

5. Shivaji's policy of sending officials to different posts at intervals ensures 1

(a) accountability **(b)** power gain **(c)** corruption **(d)** friendship

6. Chauth collected from lands outside direct rule could cause 1

(a) resentment among those paying **(b)** an end of war

(c) no change **(d)** joy among all

7. If the state allows free passage for a tax of 25%, this resembles 1

(a) zakat **(b)** iqta **(c)** jizya **(d)** chauth

8. A merchant ship from Surat is attacked. This suits which event? 1

(a) Sack of Surat by Shivaji **(b)** Panipat

(c) Purandar **(d)** Agra visit

9. Which best explains why the Peshwas, not the Chhatrapatis, ran the state in the 18th century? 1

(a) Peshwas were elected **(b)** Mughals appointed them

(c) British appointed them **(d)** Chhatrapatis were weak and Peshwas able

10. Which statement about Maratha navy is accurate? 1

(a) It challenged European powers on the west coast
(b) It was never used
(c) It had no forts
(d) It ruled the Pacific

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did chauth increase Maratha influence? 2

12. How did disunity harm the Marathas? 2

13. Why might salaried officials be better than landholding officials for a ruler? 2

14. Why was Aurangzeb unable to end Maratha resistance? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the Maratha guerrilla tactics against a larger Mughal army. 3

16. Examine how language and script reflect Maratha identity. 3

17. Compare Tarabai's and Ahilyabai's types of leadership. 3

OR

Source: 'We shall not take away mango or jackfruit trees.' Explain what this shows about the ruler. 3

18. Compare the Maratha and Mughal army structures. 3

OR

Analyse the effect of the Anglo-Maratha wars on India's politics. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Compare Shivaji's and Akbar's administrative ideas. 5

OR

Imagine you are an observer at Raigad in 1674. Describe the coronation and its meaning. 5

20. Discuss the strengths and weaknesses of the Maratha confederacy. 5

OR

Evaluate the impact of the Marathas on India's political and cultural map. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND